

Canon Pixma MP198

A multifunctional device for the home user

Having an MFD (Multifunctional Device) for home use is a pretty good option as it saves space, rather than having many devices and also comes in handy when you need immediate copies of something or the other. Canon products vary from consumer to business use and ranges from simple printers to multifunctional all-in-one printers, which can print, scan, copy and even fax. The Canon Pixma MP198 is one of the new additions to Canon's range of inkjet multifunctional printers which can print, scan and copy, but lacks the fax feature and is targeted at home users.

The MP198 has a matt finish to it and is slightly on the bulky side with its dimensions being 17.7(W) x 13.9(D) x 6.7(H) inches. Installing the print cartridges is easy as there is a big poster along with the printer that gives you step-by-step visual instructions on the basics for starting out with the printer. There

are two flaps that need to be opened — one behind for loading the paper, and one in front for the paper out. The back loading extends quite a bit too. The scanner lid does not have the feature to extend, to allow big books to be scanned.

The buttons of the printer are on the right side with a single alpha-numeric display. You can set the number of copies from one to nine, or set it at a maximum of 20, which is represented by 'F' displayed if you try to go above nine.

We tested the speed at which this printer can print a simple text document and a document with colour at the settings of economy and standard. The results obtained showed there was a time difference of about 1.5 seconds between economical and standard prints for a full-page Word document. Even though there wasn't much of a difference in the times, the standard print setting looked much better in terms of smoothness and



tion throughout the image. Even though this MFD is on the bulkier side, being priced at only Rs. 4,595 is quite a steal for home users not wanting to

also had a darker black to it. The coloured test page used printed on both settings had a 13.3 seconds difference in print times. There was also significant quality difference visible between the two. The economic print had a very grainy and pixelated picture quality. We did notice that in the printouts, in one of the images the yellow was pulling into the magenta a bit.

We also tested the printing of a high-resolution test photo on photo paper, which took a total of 4 minutes and 18 seconds. The result was a fairly good quality which did show some increase in the shadows. Scanning of a photo took 28.6 secs, but did not look too good. Colours were washed out and we also noticed some grainy pixela-

spend a lot on printers. It does lack a few features like USB plug-in, fax and is not one of the best printers in terms of colour quality, but as it is user friendly and does not cost much, it is a good buy.

Specifications

Dimensions - 17.7 x 13.9 x 6.7 inches, Print resolution: 4800 x 1200 pixels, prints up to 8 inches and 8.5 inches

Contact: Canon India Pvt Ltd
Phone No: 1800-180-33-66
Email: info@canon.co.in
Website: www.canon.co.in
Price: 4,595

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Intex IN 2266

Compact entry-level phone

Intex is a company that has recently seen an increase in the number of its products. Mobile phones are one of its less known products. The Intex IN 2266 is an entry-level mobile phone packed with quite a few features for a phone in this category.

Firstly the looks — it's glossy cherry red all over, and easily fits in your palm. It's also very light. The buttons are a bit cramped and the screen size is also very small with 64k colour and a resolution of 240 x 240 pixels QVGA display. The loud-

speaker is located behind, and the slot for the hands-free is on the side of the phone. The phone allows you to expand memory up to 2GB via a T-flash microSD memory slot, which is next to the SIM card slot.

The phone still has fea-



tures like FM, GPRS, MP3 playback and MMS. You can use the speaker to listen to music or use it as a loudspeaker when making calls. The FM radio has an auto-tune feature and can store up to 30 channels. The recording includes scheduled FM recording where the time and frequency for recording can be set. The phone also has a scheduled power on/off feature that is useful to some users.

The phone is still a great buy with all its features like FM and music playback, since it is priced only at Rs. 2,999.

Specifications

FM radio, MMS, WAP, GSM 900/1800, Expandable memory slot (up to 2 GB), Polyphonic Ringtones, 1000 number phonebook, 100 SMS memory, 188 SMS storage

Contact: Intex Technologies (India) Ltd
Phone: 1800116789
Email: info@intextechnologies.com
Website: www.intextechnologies.com
Price: Rs. 2,999

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Thermaltake Xaser VI

A hardcore cabinet for the hardcore gamer

Thermaltake is a well known name in the world of gaming peripherals, from PSUs to PC cabinets. The Xaser VI is a full tower chassis meant solely for hardcore gaming enthusiasts.

The Xaser VI is a black and red tower with metal dust filters on both sides to give a transparent look and feel. The material used is sturdy and the thickness of the metal is pretty much adequate. It's not as impressive as the Cooler Master Stackler or the Cosmos.

The I/O panel has space for two e-SATA ports, four USB ports, a FireWire and an audio in/out. Though this case carries so much, the cover for the panel was quite weak and the clips holding it looked like it was not going to last very long. The power button is shaped as an 'X,' which

looked stylish but is not made of the best quality. The reset button is tiny and a bit hard to push.

Some of the thumb-screws at the back are inaccessible and need to be opened with a screw driver. Putting them back needs patience as well.

The case has three fans, and the one on top is blocked by the ceiling of the case. On looking further into the top, we found that the top panel can be moved a bit towards the back giving the fan a bit more space to blow air, but that leaves a large section of the plate hanging out over the back of the case.

The power supply is mounted on top and a support beam is present to bear some of the weight. The support beam can be adjusted as well. There are HDD

cages which can be locked easily as well as drive bays having slide-in locks. There is also an extra drawer bay, which you can attach and use as CD/DVD storage if needed.

This case is pretty big and aimed at enthusiasts. The fan cables are coated with rubber. SATA cables and loads of extras such as zip ties are thrown in for cable management. There are plenty of empty open spaces in the cabinet, so expect dusting the insides every now and then. For the price of Rs. 13,500, it's overpriced and not totally worth the money you pay.



Firewire x 1, HD Audio

Contact: Tirupati Enterprises
Phone no: 9339207519
Email: mail@tirupati.net
Website: www.tirupati.net
Price: Rs. 13,500

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Specifications

Dimensions: 23.8 x 9.8 x 26.0 inch, Drive Bay : 7, 10 Expansion slots, Front I/O: e-SATA connector x 2, USB2.0 x 4, IEEE 1394

Motorola Motozine ZN5

A Motorola phone with a 5MP camera

Motorola mobile phones have mostly been driven by style, especially with their MotoRazr range of phones. The MotoRokr series followed and was aimed at music lovers. This new one is called the Motozine ZN5 and it comes with loads of features including a 5-MP Kodak camera and is aimed at users who want all the features a phone can offer including the looks of a phone.

The phone is thin and slides into your pocket easily. The upper section of the back has a bulge due to the lens of the camera. The back panel is a little tricky to remove.

This phone is like a jigsaw puzzle with different colours and all kinds of materials used all over in bits and pieces. The base of the phone is made of a rubber material. The camera button is a nice metallic purple giving it a good distinguishing factor. A nifty slide button on the right of the phone is present which serves the purpose of locking the phone. This is a good step forward, rather than the old conventional mode of key presses to lock the phone. The keypad is completely flat with really tiny stud-

like projections protruding out to indicate where to actually press.

The camera delivers pretty good images. There are also quick buttons for delete, share and gallery on the keypad when the phone is in camera and gallery mode.

The phone has a loudspeaker, but is not that great as the sound is rather flat. The supplied earbuds on the other hand are much better in terms of sound quality with a decent mid-range and even a hint of bass. The phone has a 3.5-mm jack, which means you can also plug in your own earplugs. The only other complaint is that the phone heats up a bit with prolonged use. The call quality was pretty good as far as being in an area with full network reception goes.

The Motozine ZN5 is a pretty good phone, but is a little too late for the market. At Rs. 17,583, it still offers good competition to the N82. If you are on a tight budget, this is a good buy.

Specifications

2.4-inch LCD 240x320 pixel display, 5-MP camera, 512 MB internal memory expandable to 4 GB via micro SD card, Wi-Fi.

Contact: Motorola
Phone no: 0124 - 2303212
Website: www.motorola.com
Price: Rs. 17,583

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆